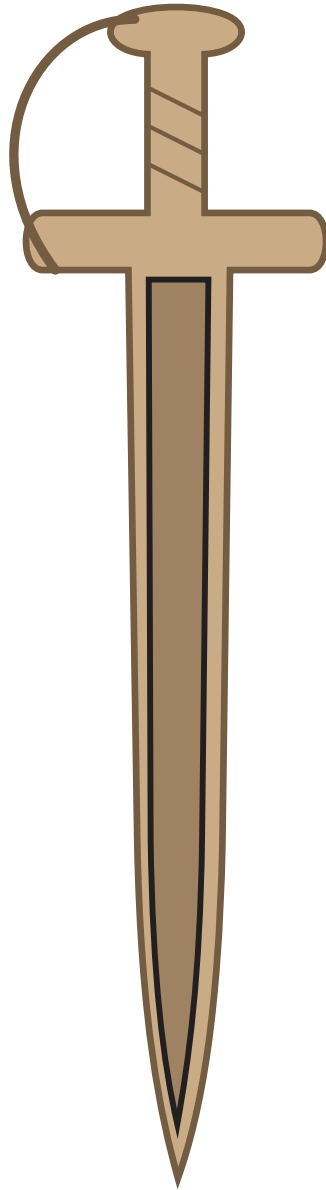




PIRATE CUTLASS

step by step guide



MEASURE TWICE • CUT ONCE • HAVE FUN

Cardboard Studio — our family workshop



What you need

MATERIALS

- Corrugated cardboard — one large box (double-wall is best for the blade)
- White glue or hot glue
- String or cloth tape for the grip wrap (optional)
- Paint or markers to decorate (optional)

TOOLS

- Scissors or craft knife (grown-up job!)
- Metal ruler
- Pencil
- Printer + tape for the template

FINISHED SIZE

8" x 19"

DIFFICULTY

2 of 3

BUILD TIME

About 1 hour (plus drying time)

AGES

5+ with a grown-up

SAFETY: Craft knives and hot glue are for grown-ups. Kids trace, fold, tape and decorate!



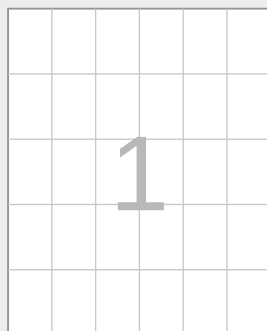
Paper size

INTERNATIONAL (EUROPEAN)

A4



210 x 297 mm
8-1/4 x 11-3/4 in



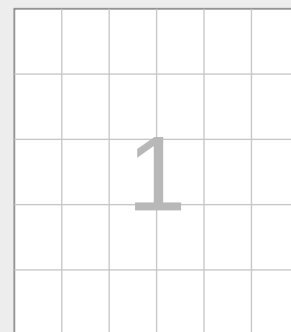
Template part has more height

NORTH AMERICA

Letter size



8.5 x 11 in
216 x 279 mm



Template part has more width



NOTE - printer set up



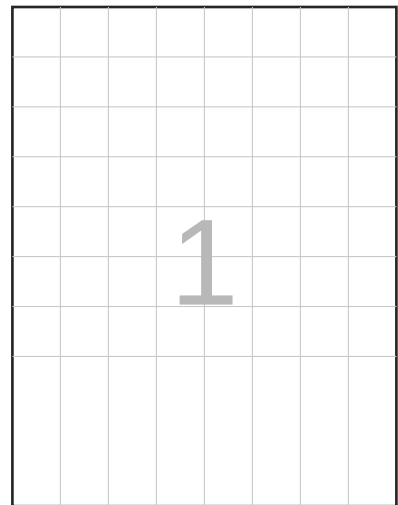
Be sure your printer
is set to print in 100%
ACTUAL SIZE



Print

Page Sizing & Handling

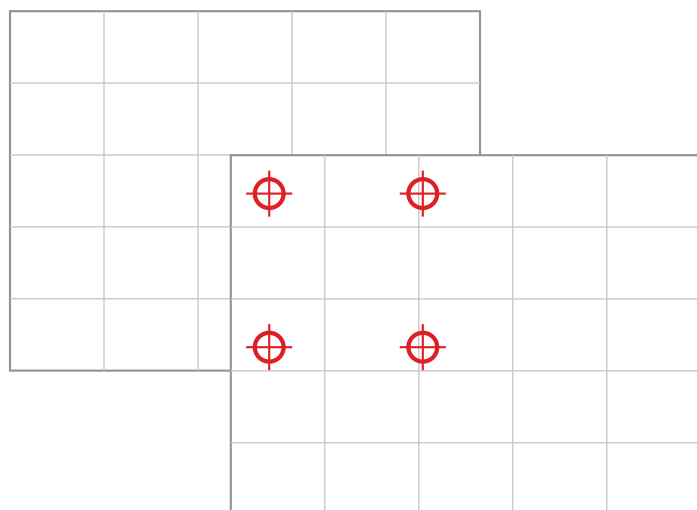
- ☐ Fit
- ☒ **Actual size** ✓
- ☐ Shrink oversized pages
- ☐ Custom Scale: 100%



Page 1 of 3

By default settings the printer shrinks the image to fit its printing area and your template will come out smaller. Each printer has its own paper margin and will not print right to the edge — that is OK: every page includes extra overlap so no detail is lost.

Pages overlap and positioning



① **Overlap**

All pages include an extra margin for overlap, so no details of the template are lost. The exact overlap depends on your printer.

② **1 inch grid (2.54 cm) / 3 inch grid (7.62 cm)**

The grid helps you align the pages perfectly in place. Light lines are 1 inch apart; heavy lines are 3 inches apart.

③ **3x3 inch square**

Overlap the pages until the visible squares measure exactly 1 inch and the heavy lines form 3x3 inch squares — your pattern will automatically align. Tape the pages together.

Your template pages arrange like this:



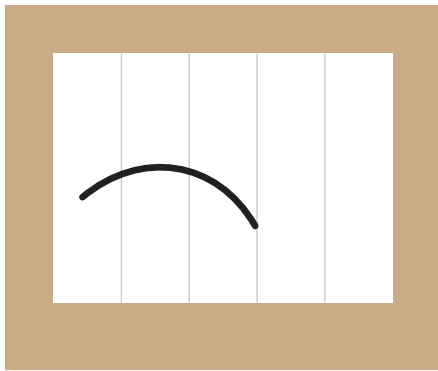
LINE UP THE GRID — THEN TAPE THE PAGES

Tracing

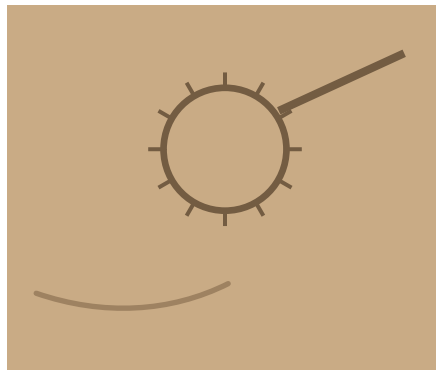
Method 1.

1. Cut Out the Template: carefully cut out the shapes from the printed template using scissors.
2. Secure the Template: place the template pieces on the cardboard and secure with tape or small weights so nothing slips.
3. Trace the Outline: use a pencil or pen to trace around the edges of the template onto the cardboard.
4. Check Your Lines: double-check every piece is traced before removing the template.

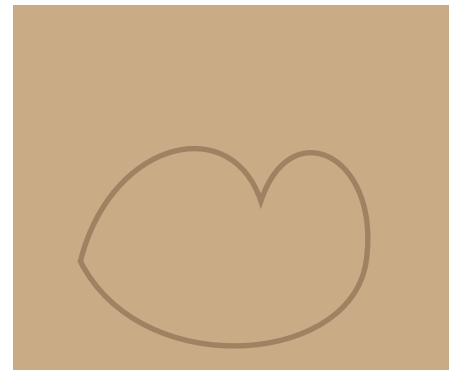
Method 2.



- ① Tape it
and trace it



- ② Tracing tool
a pen with pressure, or a tracing
wheel



- ③ Ready to cut out

NOTE - mind cardboard structure direction

The arrow on each template part shows the direction of the corrugated cardboard flutes. Keep the arrow parallel to the little waves inside your cardboard — parts stay strong and bend where they should.

Tip: the best way to bend cardboard smoothly is to cut slits halfway through on one side. Crease the slits with your fingernail to bend the other way and keep the front smooth.





NOTE - tips and tricks



HOW TO CUT CARDBOARD

PERFECT STRAIGHT CUT

Use a sharp blade and a metal ruler. Cut in 2–3 light passes instead of one hard press.

CUT A PAPER BLEED

Measure your cardboard thickness, cut half through, then peel off the corrugated layer leaving one paper face. Glue sticks much better on the bleed.

CUT A PERFECT CIRCLE

Mark the radius on a cardboard scrap, poke a pin through one end and a pencil through the other — instant compass. Cut just outside the line, then trim.



HOW TO GLUE CARDBOARD

QUICK CONNECTION — HOT GLUE

Fix the panels with tape first, open the joint like a book, run hot glue in the groove, close and tape again. Quick and sturdy for small parts.

BIG PANELS — WHITE GLUE

Add a little water to white glue and mix. Spread on the bottom part, lay the top parts like a mosaic so they overlap seams, press under books and let dry completely.

SEAMLESS OVERLAP

Make a paper bleed on the edges, apply white glue on the bottom part and the bleed, connect the matching parts, press and let dry.



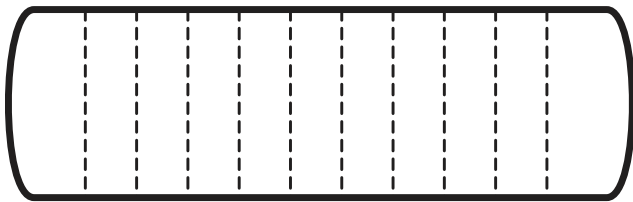
Step 1. Print, tape and trace



① Sword Body — trace TWICE.



② Blade Top Layer — trace TWICE.



③ Knuckle Guard strip — trace ONCE.

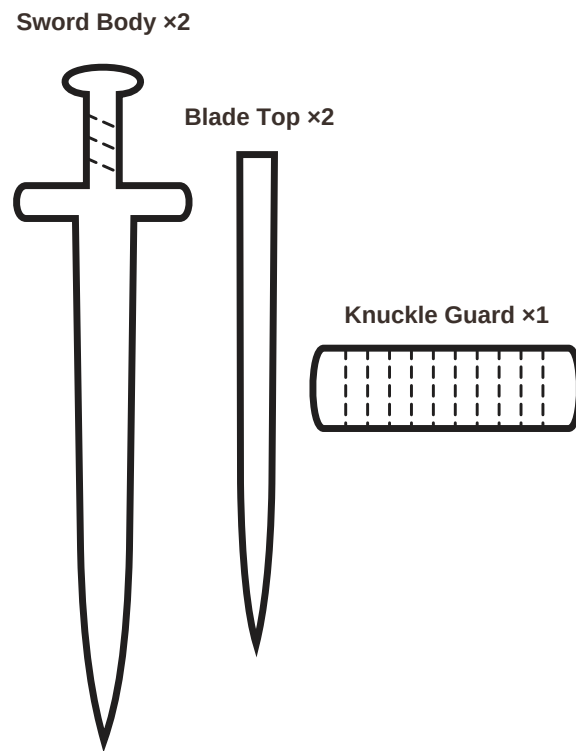
1. Print the template at 100% actual size and tape the pages together using the grid.
2. Trace the Sword Body TWICE, the Blade Top Layer TWICE, and the Knuckle Guard ONCE onto cardboard.
3. Keep the corrugation arrows lined up with the little waves inside the cardboard — that makes the blade strong.

CHECK: You should have 5 pencil outlines: 2 big swords, 2 slim blade layers, 1 slitted strip.

TIP: Trace on the plain side of the cardboard so pencil lines are easy to see.



Step 2. Cut out the parts



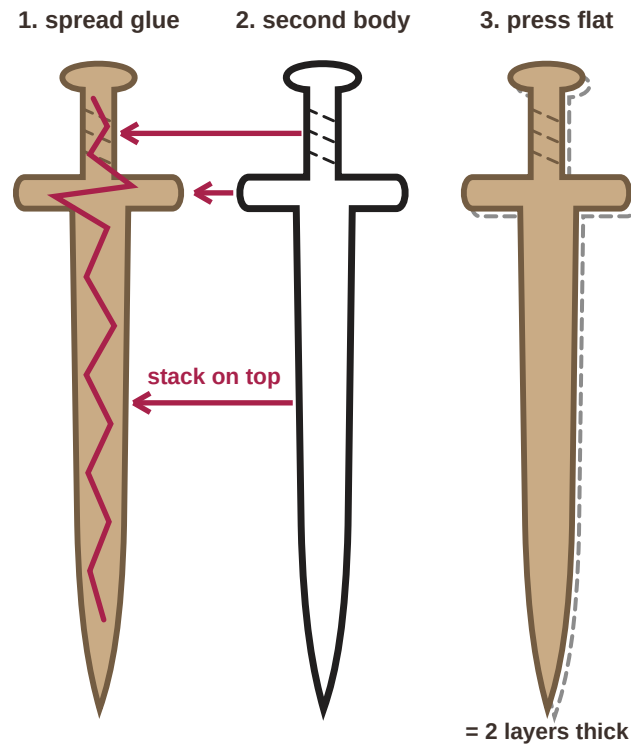
① Your full cut list — 5 pieces. Dashed lines are NOT cuts: score them half-deep only.

1. Grown-up job: cut along all solid lines with a sharp knife and metal ruler, in 2–3 light passes.
2. Kids can help by holding the ruler and peeling the offcuts.
3. Do NOT cut the dashed lines — those get scored lightly (half-deep) for folding and wrapping.

CHECK: 5 cut pieces, and every dashed line is still uncut on the front face.



Step 3. Glue the two body layers



① Glue covers the whole first sword; the second sword stacks straight onto it, edges matching all around.

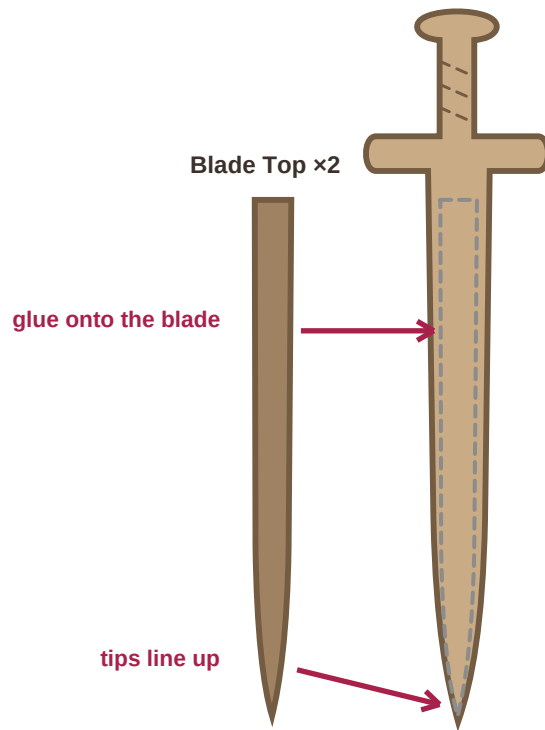
1. Cover one Sword Body with a thin layer of white glue, right to the edges.
2. Stack the second Sword Body on top, lining up the pommel, crossguard and blade tip exactly.
3. Press it flat under a stack of books while it dries — this makes the blade stiff and straight.

CHECK: Edges line up all around with no layer sticking out, and the blade does not flex when you wave it.

TIP: In a hurry? A grown-up can use hot glue in a zigzag instead — press for 30 seconds.



Step 4. Add the blade top layers

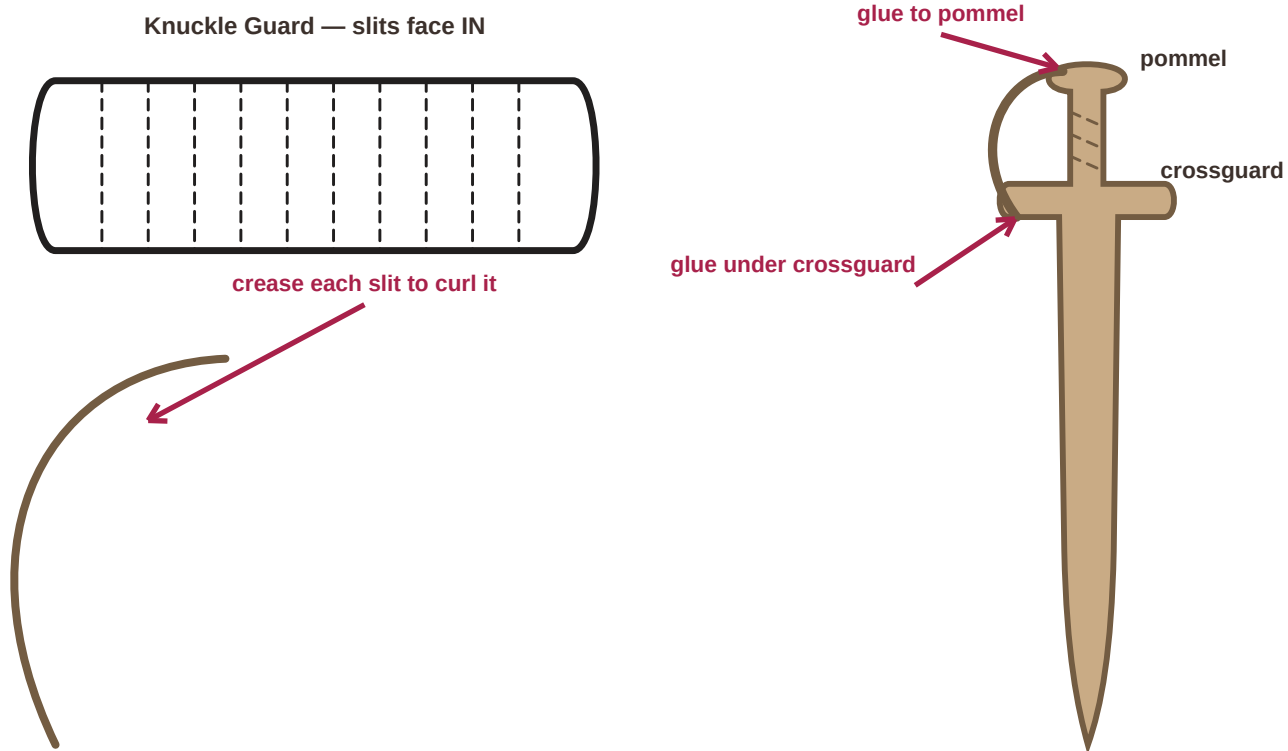


① The Blade Top lands on the dashed outline — centered on the blade, tip matching the sword tip. Flip the sword and repeat on the back.

1. Glue one Blade Top Layer down the middle of the blade on the front side — the dashed outline in the diagram shows exactly where it lands.
2. Flip the sword over and glue the second one on the back, in the same spot.
3. Line each layer's tip up with the blade tip — an even strip of flat blade, about a finger wide, should show along both edges.

CHECK: The blade has a raised ridge down the middle on BOTH sides, and all three tips meet at one point.

Step 5. Bend and attach the knuckle guard



① Crease every slit so the flat strip curls into a big C, slits on the inside of the curve.

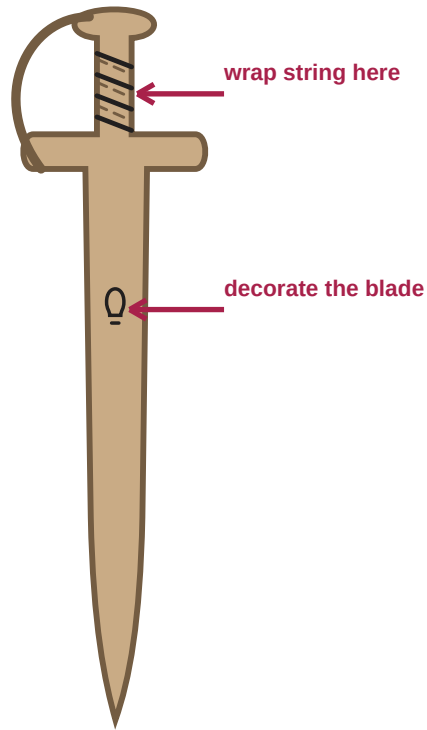
② The C bridges from the underside of the crossguard up to the pommel — hot-glue both ends where the arrows point.

1. Crease each dashed slit on the Knuckle Guard with your fingernail so the strip curves smoothly — slits face IN, toward your fingers.
2. Hot-glue one end to the underside of the crossguard, on the side your fingers wrap.
3. Curve it around and glue the other end to the pommel (the round knob at the top of the grip).
4. Hold each end for 30 seconds while the glue sets. Grown-up job — hot glue is HOT!

CHECK: Your fingers fit comfortably between the grip and the guard, and both glued ends hold when you tug gently.



Step 6. Wrap the grip and decorate

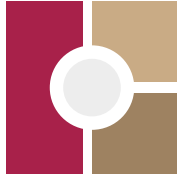


① The finished cutlass: string-wrapped grip, curved knuckle guard, decorated blade.

1. Wrap string or cloth tape around the grip, following the scored diagonal lines — it looks great and feels grippy.
2. Paint the blade silver or gray, the guard gold, and the grip brown or black.
3. Captain's touch: draw a skull, an anchor, or your ship's name on the blade!

CHECK: The wrap doesn't slide when you squeeze the grip — you're ready to set sail!

TIP: Acrylic paint works, but markers are faster and never warp the cardboard.



CARDBOARD STUDIO

MADE AT HOME, FOR HOME.

This template was designed in our family workshop. Print it, build it, smash it, rebuild it better. Share it with friends — and send us a photo of what you made!

BUILT WITH

Cardboard Studio

Design: Pirate Cutlass • 2026